



Choose Docker when your applications can run on Linux (or Windows containers for Windows applications), when you need frequent deployments, or when cost optimisation through higher density is important. Docker is also the clear choice for development environment standardisation and CI/CD pipeline integration.

Virtual machines remain the better choice for scenarios requiring complete isolation, diverse operating system support, or compatibility with legacy applications that cannot be easily containerised. Organisations with strict compliance requirements, complex multi-tenant environments, or existing investments in VM-based infrastructure should continue leveraging VMs where appropriate.

A hybrid approach often provides the best solution, using VMs for foundational infrastructure and isolation boundaries while running containerised applications within those VMs. This combination leverages the strengths of both technologies, providing robust isolation when needed while maintaining the efficiency and agility of containers for application workloads.

Consider your team's expertise, existing infrastructure, security requirements, and long-term architectural goals when making technology decisions. Both Docker and VMs have proven track records and will continue evolving to meet changing requirements.

The future likely involves both technologies coexisting and evolving to address different aspects of infrastructure and application management. Understanding their respective strengths and appropriate use cases enables informed decisions that align technology choices with business objectives and technical requirements.

Success in modern infrastructure management requires understanding both approaches and applying them appropriately based on specific requirements, constraints, and objectives. Whether you choose Docker, VMs, or a hybrid approach, focus on solutions that enable your organisation to deliver value efficiently while meeting security, compliance, and operational requirements.

The key is not choosing one technology over another universally but rather understanding when each approach provides the greatest benefit for your specific use case and organisational context. **END** 🐧

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